

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 19, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 5:1–13

1 It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even named among the Gentiles—that a man has his father's wife!

2 And you are puffed up, and have not rather mourned, that he who has done this deed might be taken away from among you.

3 For I indeed, as absent in body but present in spirit, have already judged (as though I were present) him who has so done this deed.

4 In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when you are gathered together, along with my spirit, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,

5 deliver such a one to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.

6 Your glorying is not good. Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump?

7 Therefore purge out the old leaven, that you may be a new lump, since you truly are unleavened. For indeed Christ, our Passover, was sacrificed for us.

8 Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old leaven, nor with the leaven of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

9 I wrote to you in my epistle not to keep company with sexually immoral people.

10 Yet I certainly did not mean with the sexually immoral people of this world, or with the covetous, or extortioners, or idolaters, since then you would need to go out of the world.

11 But now I have written to you not to keep company with anyone named a brother, who is sexually immoral, or covetous, or an idolater, or a reviler, or a drunkard, or an extortioner—not even to eat with such a person.

12 For what have I to do with judging those also who are outside? Do you not judge those who are inside?

13 But those who are outside God judges. Therefore "put away from yourselves the evil person."

II. Key Summary

- The Corinthian church wasn't just tolerating a member's sin — they were actually proud of their "openness," an attitude Paul found more troubling than the sin itself
 - "A little leaven leavens the whole lump": one unaddressed wrong quietly shifts the standards and culture of an entire community
 - Paul's instruction to remove the offender was aimed at his restoration and salvation, not punishment — discipline points toward healing, not condemnation
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III. Passage Analysis

Topic 1: Sometimes, "Tolerance" Is Its Own Kind of Harm

"You don't show 'love' to a body by being kind to a cancer!" [1]

The Corinthians thought accepting a sinning brother without challenge showed how loving and open-minded they were — and they were even proud of it. But Paul argues that letting sin spread unchecked through the community isn't love. Just as ignoring a tumor doesn't help the body, tolerating unrepentant sin ends up hurting everyone.

Topic 2: Discipline Is About Bringing Someone Back, Not Shutting Them Out

"The purpose of discipline is to lead to the humbling of them, and bringing them to a sense of their sins, and a true repentance." [2]

"Delivering someone to Satan" sounds severe, but Paul states the goal clearly in verse 5: "that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus." Removing someone from fellowship is meant to give them a chance to face reality — church discipline has always pointed toward restoration, not rejection.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever watched a friend do something clearly wrong, but stayed quiet because you didn't want to make things awkward?

If someone had spoken up in that moment, do you think it would have hurt your friend — or shown them a different kind of care?

References

- [1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-5/>
- [2] BibleHub.com, Matthew Henry's Commentary,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/5-5.htm